STEAL & ADAPT

BAND A

GOOD PRACTICE FROM YOUR BAND

Examples of good practice around collaboration within the CFA teams, FACCs and other CFA support staff from Counties in your band. What could you steal and adapt for your County?

BIRMINGHAM FA

Knowle were a grassroots Club when we first started with them with no legal structure and no disability provision. We completed a Club Development Review with Knowle who were sitting top in their Men's RFL at the time and identified facilities and L&G as two areas to focus on.

- Deployed our facilities team to support with the facilities which are now Step 5 standard.
- Deployed a consultant to support with the L&G and they now have a legal structure.
- Deployed Development Leads to strengthen pathways, club now 3*.

LANCASHIRE FA

NLS – West Didsbury & Chorlton. Met their committee and did their review alongside Steve Hobson FACC. They took it away and put together an action plan to develop against the framework as well as a plan for their facility/ground.

This plan has had comments and feedback from their local FDO, W+G lead, Facilities lead, Club lead and FACC to make sure it is robust and now can be acted on going forwards.

STEAL & ADAPT

BAND B

GOOD PRACTICE FROM YOUR BAND

Examples of good practice around collaboration within the CFA teams, FACCs and other CFA support staff from Counties in your band. What could you steal and adapt for your County?

LIVERPOOL FA

Following the club review, the CFA sent them a detailed club development plan that outlined the priority areas of the club review, providing guidance and actions on how to improve these areas. It was highlighted that the club's pitch quality was poor, as was the inclusivity and the funding & investment into their facilities. Our Facilities & Investment Manager has since met with the club to discuss accessing Grass Pitch Maintenance Fund and to redevelop their clubhouse.

An FA Club Consultant was assigned to support the club's legal structure and financial controls. Priorities are becoming incorporated and creating an asset transfer. The club were encouraged to have a demo with a partner organisation to discuss a stronger financial model. 80 members completed a club survey, and they have been able to create a club purpose, vision, mission, values and strategic aims.

Finally, the club's comms & marketing was answered poor in the club review, they have been assigned 2 sport business and marketing students from Liverpool John Moores University to support them with creating a comms & marketing strategy.

MIDDLESEX FA

Football Samurai completed a Club Development Review alongside three County FA staff and FA Club Consultant. Club identified shortfalls across the five pillars.

The Club Consultant supported the club regularly over 7 hours of 1:1 support in helping develop their Legal Structure, financial management and a bespoke marketing plan.

The club engaged with the following support:

- Face-to-face Introduction to Legal Structures workshop delivered by the CFA.
- CFA 3v3 face-to-face practical workshop.
- Volunteers & Coaches workshop delivered by the County FA.
- Facilities & Investment online workshop.
- The County FA Safeguarding team reviewed Safeguarding policies and shared guidance and best practice to be implemented across the club. They put themselves forward for a Safeguarding visit, completed by CFA staff.

Coach Delivery Lead is supporting the diverse coaching workforce within the club. They were rewarded with tickets to an England Men's game to recognise & celebrate their volunteers.

This demonstrates a broad impact across the five pillars through support from various individuals.

STEAL & ADAPT

BAND C

GOOD PRACTICE FROM YOUR BAND

Examples of good practice around collaboration within the CFA teams, FACCs and other CFA support staff from Counties in your band. What could you steal and adapt for your County?

LINCOLNSHIRE FA

NLS – Stamford AFC. Engaged with Lincolnshire FA regarding the CPD Programme, running a CPD session impacting the coaches at the club with additional coaching.

Stamford AFC are based right next to a college and have created a partnership between the club and the college, utilising college students in volunteer roles at the club.

CFA recommended creating and completing a survey for all coaches, and one for parents due to them having 30+ teams, creating a "You said, we did" article and a really good news piece.

STEAL & ADAPT

BAND D

GOOD PRACTICE FROM YOUR BAND

Examples of good practice around collaboration within the CFA teams, FACCs and other CFA support staff from Counties in your band. What could you steal and adapt for your County?

EAST RIDING FA

A Club Development Review highlighted that the club's existing legal structure (unincorporated) was no longer appropriate for an organisation of its size and complexity. This exposed key volunteers to personal liability.

The club lacked formal security of tenure at its primary playing site, creating a substantial risk around long-term facility access. The club was not fully meeting the requirements for complete player pathways, limiting its ability to provide inclusive and progressive opportunities.

CFA deployed a FACC to work with the club's leadership team. A structured programme of support was implemented, focusing on governance, facilities, and player development.

Key interventions included:

- **Transition to a Charitable Incorporated Organisation (CIO):** FACC is supporting the club in moving from an unincorporated structure to a CIO.
- **Securing Facility Usage:** FACC worked to develop and agree a formal Service Level Agreement (SLA) between the school & club, providing greater security of tenure and clarity over facility access.
- **Expanding Inclusive Provision:** A Disability Ambassador was deployed to support the launch of Comets sessions, ensuring the club could evidence a fully inclusive offer.

The introduction of Comets sessions has ensured the club now meets the criteria for full player pathways and progressed to 3-star England Football Accreditation.

STAFFORDSHIRE FA

One of the most impactful interventions delivered through the Club 28 programme over the past twelve months was our work with Burntwood Dragons & Phoenix.

Club Development Review Findings
The review identified several priority areas that were limiting the club's ability to sustain and manage its growth effectively. The support came from multiple members of CFA staff and FACC.

These interventions led to significant and tangible improvements across the club:

- **Increased Participation:** Expansion of provision across female and disability football. (FDOs)
- **Workforce Growth and Development:** Improved support and development opportunities for coaches and volunteers, helping to recruit, retain, and inspire individuals across the club. (Coach Dev Lead)
- **Stronger Club Structure:** Clearer governance, defined roles, and improved communication processes have enhanced decision-making. (FACC)
- **Improved Facilities and Infrastructure:** Better access to 3G provision, improved grass pitch maintenance, and plans for clubhouse redevelopment. (CFA Facilities team)
- **Strategic and Sustainable Planning:** The introduction of a structured development plan has shifted the club towards a more proactive and sustainable model of growth. (CFA & FACC)

Demonstrable Progress: The club has completed over 13 priority actions and received more than 26 hours of face-to-face Club 28 support, alongside a significantly strengthened working relationship with Staffordshire FA.

WILTSHIRE FA

Supporting Wroughton Youth FC, currently a 2-star accredited club, focused conversations on club ambitions for the next five years, particularly around governance, facilities and player pathways.

Support has been delivered collaboratively across the Wiltshire FA team. I've led on player pathways, supporting their development of a new pan-disability team and the formation of their new Wildcats programme alongside our Football Development Officers.

Our facilities lead was involved in meetings from the CDR onwards and has supported the club to be identified as a potential partner club for a new 3G project.

Our FACC supported the club around changing their legal structure from unincorporated to charity status.

The progress and change at the club have resulted in regular meetings with a designated Community sub-committee they've appointed to complete the Club Impact Calculator and providing them support around the club merging with two neighbouring (open age male) clubs. The club is well placed to become a 3-star Thriving Community Club.

BEDFORDSHIRE FA

NLS – The CFA has facilitated a partnership between Crawley Green FC (NLS Step 5)/Crawley Green Youth FC and Luton Town Ladies FC (WFP Tier 4), which has been impactful to local football.

Through ongoing Club Development Review meetings and strategic discussions, Bedfordshire FA supported both clubs to collaborate and strengthen their long-term sustainability and provide more inclusive football opportunities. Luton Town Ladies FC has an established girls' and women's provision, whilst Crawley Green FC/Crawley Green Youth FC have a well-established male football pathway.

The ambition was to achieve 3* England Football Accreditation. We initially supported both clubs to become linked for Accreditation. CFA deployed our Disability Football Ambassador to Luton Town Ladies to develop disability provision at the club.

Our Disability Football Ambassador then linked a local Disability group (Disability in Action) to the club. The Disability in Action coach has been supported by the club to achieve FA qualifications and start delivery of the PAN disability sessions in Luton. Luton Town Ladies have affiliated a U16s PAN disability team.

Working together the clubs have achieved 3* England Football Accreditation through creating opportunities for male, female, and disability players to access football.

This intervention provided the opportunity for both clubs to explore having a stadia 3G developed to support both winter training and fixtures for their senior teams (Crawley Green FC and Luton Town Ladies). Achieving 3* Accreditation has strengthened the clubs to apply for Premier League Stadia funding and Football Foundation grants.